

PROJECT NAME: <i>Corporate deGIFer</i>		PROJECT AUTHOR: <i>INCO team</i>	
Big Idea <i>My plan is to reduce the digital carbon footprint of my company by removing GIFs from our company email signature.</i>	Organizational Readiness score: 4/5 <i>My company provides educational courses around the world. Their aim is to build a new, sustainable and inclusive economy. Their mission is to boost equality in future-driven industries.</i>	Functional Readiness score: 5/5 <i>This is 5/5 because it would be easy to implement. It just may take time to make the decision company-wide.</i>	Technical Readiness score: 4/5 <i>I think it is 4/5 because I'm not sure how we could (efficiently) monitor whether every individual has changed their signature, nor how we could measure the total impact of this idea, e.g. how much CO2 was avoided from removing the GIF. That said, it really only requires individuals to delete the GIF, which only takes a few seconds.</i>
Vision <i>Everyone at my company uses the same email signature, which includes a GIF image (animated image).</i> <i>During the Green Digital Skills course, I have learned that emails and GIFs produce CO2 emissions. I am motivated to raise awareness of this fact and to reduce the CO2 output of unnecessary emails.</i> <i>Removing the GIF file from the signature is a simple change that can immediately reduce our digital carbon footprint.</i> <i>I will calculate the difference in CO2 equivalents (CO2e) between sending emails with and without GIF images. I will prove to my company that they can be much more sustainable with one insignificant change.</i>	<i>Given the above, I'm confident that they would be willing to make such a small change to announce the large benefits of my idea.</i> <i>I think the readiness is 4/5 because it may require policy change, a company-wide announcement would be required, and then it would still require individuals to implement the changes.</i>		

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Project Description <i>If there are 60 employees at the company, and each employee sends about 5 emails per day with their email signature attached, then the total number of emails sent with GIFs attached is 300 per day</i> <i>300 emails per day x 260 working days per year = 78,000 emails per year</i> <i>The CO2 emission from a single email ~ 0.3g</i> <i>The approximate CO2 emission from an email with a GIF (since GIFs are big files with slow load times) ~ 10g</i> <i>The total CO2 emissions from an email with a GIF x 78,000 emails = 780kg per year</i>	Stakeholders Implicated <i>All employees will need to change their signatures. We could also share our change with external stakeholders to create wider change, e.g. clients, customers, learners</i>	Gap <i>This idea requires very little shift from the company's aims or processes. Readiness levels are high so it should be an easy win.</i>	Success Criteria <i>Make one other advocate for environmental improvements in the team.</i> <i>Remove GIF-s from 50% of sent e-mails in 60 days.</i>
	Strategies <i>Calculate the true number of emails sent daily/weekly by company staff; identify how many of those include the company signature and GIF; calculate the true CO2 output of such emails.</i> <i>Once this is known, I can make a stronger case for implementing this change, and the company can make a more accurate/honest announcement of the CO2 avoided without mistakenly greenwashing.</i>		Next steps <i>Determine the value of GIFs on email signatures - who made the decision? Why?</i> <i>Work with Communications department to see if the objectives of the email signature could be met without a GIF.</i> <i>Create easy instructions for coworkers on how to remove GIF-s.</i> <i>Work with HR and upper management to roll out a plan to re-educate INCO employees on company email signature policy.</i>
Objectives <i>Remove GIF image from ALL company email signatures.</i> <i>Possibly even switch the GIF for a note that says, "We have removed our GIF from our email signature to reduce ~9g of CO2e".</i>		Drivers <i>Our company's website displayed, "1.5M tons of CO² avoided = 66M trees" - I think they would like to increase this figure by reducing their digital carbon footprint also.</i>	